

CLASS - 12th

SUBJECT - ENGLISH

PROSE + POETRY + STORY OF ENGLISH

CLASS 12TH BIHAR BOARD – ENGLISH (RAINBOW PART 2)

POETRY CHAPTER 1: SWEETEST LOVE I DO NOT GOE (BY JOHN DONNE)

CHAPTER SUMMARY (IN 50 WORDS)

"Sweetest Love I Do Not Go" is a beautiful metaphysical poem by John Donne. He comforts his beloved wife before leaving for a journey, assuring her that his departure is not out of weariness. Donne beautifully explains that true lovers never part spiritually, and death cannot separate them.

12 IMPORTANT SHORT SUBJECTIVE QUESTIONS & ANSWERS

Q1. Why does the poet want to go away from his beloved?

Ans: The poet wants to go away on a short journey not because he is tired of his beloved, nor because he expects a better love from the world, but to prepare himself for the ultimate separation of death.

Q2. What comparison does the poet draw with the sun?

Ans: The poet compares himself to the sun, stating that just as the sun departed last night and returned today without any desires, he will also return much faster because he has a strong motive and wings of love.

Q3. What makes a man's power feeble or weak according to the poem?

Ans: A man's power becomes feeble because when bad fortune strikes, he cannot recall a single good hour or add another moment to his life, making him helpless before fate.

Q4. How does the beloved waste the poet's life?

Ans: The beloved wastes the poet's life by sighing and weeping excessively. When she sighs, she exhales his soul, and when she weeps, his life-blood decays.

Q5. In what way do unkindness and crying harm the poet?

Ans: The beloved's crying and sighing act like cruelty to the poet. Since her soul contains his life, her deep sorrow weakens the poet physically and emotionally.

Q6. What does the poet advise his beloved not to do before his departure?

Ans: The poet advises his beloved not to foresee any evil or bad fortune for him in her heart, as destiny might fulfill her fears and make them come true.



CLASS - 12th SUBJECT - ENGLISH PROSE + POETRY + STORY OF ENGLISH

Q7. How can true lovers overcome the pain of physical separation?

Ans: True lovers can overcome separation by keeping each other alive in their memories. Those who remain present in each other's hearts are never truly parted.

Q8. Why is John Donne called a "Metaphysical Poet"?

Ans: He is called a metaphysical poet because his poems combine deep intellect, philosophy, wit, and unusual scientific comparisons to explain human emotions like love and death.

Q9. What assurance does the poet give to his wife?

Ans: He assures her that his journey is temporary and he will return safely and swiftly, just like the sun completes its daily cycle.

Q10. How do the poet and his beloved live in each other?

Ans: They live in each other spiritually. Their love is so deep that their souls are interconnected, meaning one's sorrow directly affects the other's well-being.

Q11. What is the significance of the old English spellings used in the poem?

Ans: Words like "Goe", "Sunne", and "Feare" represent the Elizabethan and Jacobean eras of English literature, showing the historical period in which John Donne wrote.

Q12. What is the central message of this poem?

Ans: The central message is that true love transcends physical presence. Distance and death are powerless against two souls that are genuinely united in love.

© 35 OBJECTIVE QUESTIONS (QUESTION & OPTIONS IN SINGLE LINE)

1. 'Sweetest Love I Do Not Goe' is composed by: (A) John Keats (B) John Donne (C) Walt Whitman (D) T.S. Eliot
2. John Donne is a celebrated _____ poet.: (A) Romantic (B) Metaphysical (C) War (D) Nature
3. John Donne was born in London in 1572 into a prominent _____ family.: (A) Protestant (B) Roman Catholic (C) Hindu (D) Islamic
4. Donne was forced to leave which university without a degree due to his religion?: (A) Cambridge (B) Oxford (C) Harvard (D) Delhi University
5. John Donne was briefly sent to prison for secretly marrying his patron's: (A) sister (B) niece (C) daughter (D) mother
6. At the age of 42, John Donne accepted ordination in the _____ Church.: (A) Catholic (B) Anglican (C) Baptist (D) Orthodox
7. 'Sweetest Love I Do Not Goe' is fundamentally a: (A) war song (B) love poem / lyric (C) nature poem (D) political satire



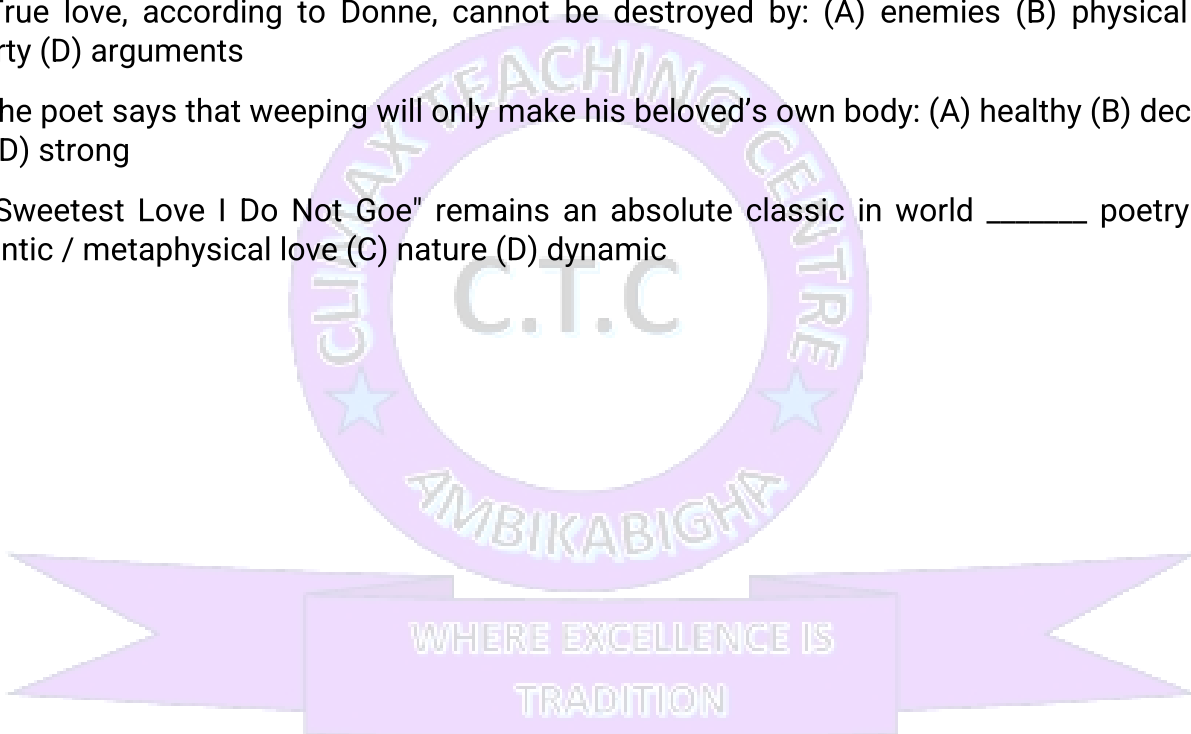
CLASS - 12th **SUBJECT - ENGLISH** **PROSE + POETRY + STORY OF ENGLISH**

8. The poet tells his beloved that he is not leaving because of: (A) weariness / tiredness (B) money problems (C) anger (D) fear of enemies
9. The poet compares his journey to the journey of the: (A) moon (B) sun (C) stars (D) wind
10. The sun went away last night and is back _____.: (A) next week (B) today (C) never (D) next year
11. According to the poet, the sun has neither desire, nor sense, nor a half-short: (A) mind (B) way / path (C) friend (D) horse
12. The poet claims that he will make speedier journeys because he has more _____ than the sun.: (A) money (B) wings and spurs of love (C) vehicles (D) friends
13. "O how feeble is man's _____!": (A) wealth (B) power (C) voice (D) body
14. When bad fortune arrives, man cannot add another: (A) dollar (B) hour / moment (C) friend (D) day
15. When the beloved sighs, she does not blow away wind, but she sighs the poet's: (A) breath (B) soul (C) wealth (D) blood
16. When the beloved weeps, the poet's life-blood: (A) increases (B) decays / wastes (C) stops completely (D) shines
17. The poet thinks that the beloved's continuous crying is a sign of: (A) kindness (B) unkindness / cruelty (C) true victory (D) wisdom
18. The poet begs his beloved not to let her divining heart think of any: (A) wealth (B) ill / evil fortune (C) beautiful songs (D) past jokes
19. Destiny may take a part and fulfill the beloved's: (A) dreams (B) fears / apprehensions (C) promises (D) wealth
20. The poet asks his beloved to consider him as merely turned aside in: (A) anger (B) bed / sleep (C) a far country (D) a meeting
21. "They who one another keep alive, ne'er _____ be.": (A) parted (B) happy (C) rich (D) forgotten
22. John Donne's well-known works include 'Songs and Sonnets', 'Satires', and: (A) Distant Drum (B) Elegies and Sermons (C) The Earth (D) Hind Swaraj
23. The poem showcases Donne's immense expertise in using intense human: (A) hatred (B) emotion and passion (C) political data (D) scientific terms
24. In the line "Yesternight the sunne went hence", the word 'sunne' means: (A) son (B) sun (C) moon (D) star
25. Man cannot join a past good hour back into his life once it is: (A) bought (B) lost / gone (C) enjoyed (D) written
26. The theme of the poem deals with love and the inevitability of: (A) wealth (B) death / separation (C) war (D) business
27. The line "Thou art my best part" signifies the poet's deep connection with his: (A) mother (B) wife / beloved (C) country (D) father
28. John Donne died in the year: (A) 1616 (B) 1631 (C) 1650 (D) 1700



CLASS - 12th SUBJECT - ENGLISH PROSE + POETRY + STORY OF ENGLISH

29. The beloved's sorrow is affecting the poet because they share a single: (A) house (B) spiritual life / bond (C) business (D) vehicle
30. The poem is written in a conversational or _____ tone.: (A) aggressive (B) dramatic / persuasive (C) political (D) boring
31. The word 'feare' in old English text represents modern: (A) fair (B) fear (C) fare (D) fire
32. John Donne became famous for his pioneering style of preaching at St. Paul's: (A) School (B) Cathedral (C) University (D) Palace
33. True love, according to Donne, cannot be destroyed by: (A) enemies (B) physical distance (C) poverty (D) arguments
34. The poet says that weeping will only make his beloved's own body: (A) healthy (B) decay / suffer (C) rich (D) strong
35. "Sweetest Love I Do Not Goe" remains an absolute classic in world _____ poetry.: (A) war (B) romantic / metaphysical love (C) nature (D) dynamic



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